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Lead Developer (Ref: 23278)

Ministry of Justice

Apply before 11:55 pm on Friday 30th October 2026

Ministry of JUSTICE

Reference number

486430

Salary

£58,511 - £70,725

The national salary range is £58,511 - £65,329, London salary range is £63,343 - £70,725. Your salary will be dependent on your base location

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7
Grade 7

Contract type

Permanent

Type of role

Digital

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Part-time

Number of jobs available

4

Contents

Location
About the job
Benefits
Things you need to know
Apply and further information

Location

East Midlands (England), East of England, London (region), North East England, North West England, Scotland, South East England, South West England, Wales, West Midlands (England), Yorkshire and the Humber

About the job

Job summary

This position is based nationally.

Job description

Lead Developer

Location: National*

Closing Date: 30th October 2026

Interviews: w/c 16th November 2026

Grade: Grade 7

(MoJ candidates who are on a specialist grade, will be able to retain this grade on lateral transfer)

Salary:** London: £63,343 - £78,225 (which may include an allowance up to £14,882)

National: £58,511 - £73,450 (which may include an allowance up to £14,939)

Working pattern: Full-time, Part-time, Flexible working

Contract Type: Permanent

Number of vacancies: 4

Vacancy number: 23278

***We offer a hybrid working model, allowing for a balance between remote work and time spent in your local office. Office locations can be found ON THIS MAP**
Please note that unless you are an existing member of staff at Justice Digital, Data and Science, the only London location being recruited to is 10 South Colonnade, E14 4PU. We are no longer recruiting to 102 Petty France, SW1H 9AJ.

The Role

Please note this role requires you to pass Security Check clearance. Please click on the link for details.

We re recruiting for **Lead Software Developers** here at Justice Digital, Data and Science to be part of our warm and collaborative **Legal Aid Agency (LAA) Digital** team.

This role aligns against Lead Developer **from the Government Digital and Data Framework.**

We really want to hear from people who value making a difference and building user-centred services using modern tools and practices as part of a highly collaborative team. We strongly encourage empathetic approaches and cross functional working and are looking for people to help build on this culture of agility and openness.

As an example, you could be helping teams that are:

· Building services to enhance an application for legal aid

· Developing services to process and review applications for legal aid caseworkers

· Providing access to court data

· Building services to provide access to historic applications

You ll receive a range of excellent benefits when you join our department, including:

· **A generous employer pension contribution of 28.97%** through the Civil Service Pension Scheme.

· **25 days of annual leave, (increasing to 30 days once you have reached 5 years of service), plus 8 bank holidays and a privilege day for the King s birthday**.

· **Flexible working arrangements** including hybrid working, working part time or compressed hours. Designed to support a positive work life balance.

· Employees are allocated **10% of their working time for personal and professional development.**

· A £1k per person learning budget is in place to support all our people, with access to best-in-class conferences and seminars, accreditation with professional bodies, fully funded vocational programmes and e-learning platforms.

· Compassionate maternity, adoption, and shared parental leave policies, with up to 26 weeks leave at full pay, 13 weeks with partial pay, and 13 weeks further leave. And maternity support/paternity leave at full pay for 2 weeks, too!

You can find more details of the Benefits we offer here**.** To help picture your life at MoJ Justice Digital, Data and Science please take a look at our blog.

Key Responsibilities:

In addition to hands-on development, you will inspire, mentor, coach, manage and lead Software Developers within a business domain. You will focus on generating a culture of quality, maintaining balance between building sustainable well architected products and unlocking citizen value early.

The areas of your responsibility for leadership will shift between people, architecture, development and product strategy, depending on context and need.

You will have responsibility for one team, or two small related teams, and report to the Principal Developers.

Technical Leadership:

· Collaborate with Technical Architects and Product Managers to set product direction

· Collaborate with Technical Architects to help in the design of systems and implementation of coherent and sustainable technical roadmaps

· Lead discussions with Developers to nurture consensus on technical/ team decisions

· Support backlog refinement, helping plan, define and prioritise actionable tasks for the team

· Build inclusivity and understanding by promoting strategies to share technical knowledge of our systems with appropriate documentation and other activities

· Support Delivery Managers in unblocking value where necessary and/or honest representations of effort in an agile environment as the teams learn more

Engineering Management:

· Managing, coaching and growing people with a focus on their wellbeing and development

· Support Delivery Managers in improving team maturity

Engineering Profession:

· Work with your local Principal Developers and the wider community to improve and maintain good coding standards and practices

· Help provide feedback on wider technical strategy of your business unit

· Share knowledge and build enthusiasm for sharing via activities like brown bags, cooperative workshops, chat discussions and other means

· Encourage open discussion and drive communities in our primary communication tools

· Have a mindset for growth and learning, looking for emerging technologies, tools and good practice

· Help build and maintain a diverse, inclusive culture across the development community, growing awareness, inclusivity, and balance

· Take part in the recruitment and onboarding of other Developers

Our Tech Stack

We rely on **Java, Python** or **Ruby** to write our application code, **GitHub Actions** for CI/CD, **Sentry** for application monitoring, **Kubernetes** and **Docker** to schedule and run our services (read about our Cloud Platform), **AWS** for most of our infrastructure, **GOV.UK Design System** for our web interfaces and use **MacBook Pros.**

For front-end development, we value a robust understanding of the underlying web technologies. We value well-maintained, open-source tools that can be used to produce semantic **HTML**, performant **CSS** and unobtrusive **JavaScript** with **Express.js** and **TypeScript,** and we assess all our services against **accessibility** criteria.

We re happy to help you learn our tech stack once you re part of our team, and do not require an exact match in your experience of languages. Check out GitHub for a closer look at the technologies we use, and a complete list of services that we build and maintain. We subscribe to the manifesto for agile software development.

If this feels like an exciting challenge, something you are enthusiastic about, and want to join our team please read on and apply!

Person Specification

Essential

- You have experience making and guiding complex technical decisions and contributing to technical strategy.

- You have experience nurturing a culture of good software practice that makes change easy.

- You have contributed towards building a high performing, inclusive team culture.

- You have experience in delivering value sooner and safer, through DevOps, XP or other ways of working that lead to agility and collaboration.

- You have experience either coaching or managing other people.

- You have been involved in building or contributing to a community of practice.

- Contribution towards the team e.g. being point of contact or team advocate, working with stakeholders, helping with Delivery Manager and Product Manager DM/PM activities, improving processes.

- Contribution towards other developers: e.g. coaching / training / inspiring; encouraging L&D.

Willingness to be assessed against the requirements for **SC** clearance

We welcome the unique contribution diverse applicants bring and do not discriminate based on culture, ethnicity, race, nationality or national origin, age, sex, gender identity or expression, religion or belief, disability status, sexual orientation, educational or social background or any other factor.

Our values are Purpose, Humanity, Openness and Together. Find out more here about how we celebrate diversity and an inclusive culture in our workplace.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan and the Civil Service D&I Strategy.

Salary Information**

Base salary for this role is from £63,343 £70,725 (**London**), or £58,511 £65,329 (**National**)

· **New entrants to the Civil Service** joining the MoJ are expected to start at the minimum of the pay band.

· **Existing Civil Servants moving on a level transfer** will retain their current base salary or move to the minimum of the pay band for the role, whichever is higher.

· **Existing Civil Servants who are promoted** will either move to the bottom of the new grade s pay band or receive a 10% uplift, whichever provides the greater increase.

· **Candidates may also be eligible for a non-pensionable Government Digital & Data Allowance of up to £14,882 per year (London) or £14,939 (National).** This is a temporary allowance, reviewed annually and may be retained, amended, or withdrawn.

The final offer will reflect the skills and experience you demonstrate during the assessment process.

How to Apply

In Justice Digital, Data and Science, we recruit using a combination of the **Government Digital and Data Profession Capability** and **Success Profiles** Frameworks. We shall assess a combination of your Experience, Technical skills and Behaviours during the assessment process.

Stage 1 - Application and sift:

To apply for this position, you must submit the following as part of your application:

· A **CV** detailing your career history (including any relevant qualifications). Your CV will be assessed against the essential criteria outlined within the Person Specification of this advert.

· A **Personal Statement** (**no more than 750 words**) which should outline your experience and skills, giving clear examples of work undertaken. It should specifically address the following **4 criteria** listed below, using a separate paragraph for each.

- You have experience making and guiding complex technical decisions and contributing to technical strategy.

- You have experience in delivering value sooner and safer, through DevOps, XP or other ways of working that lead to agility and collaboration.

- Contribution towards the team e.g. being point of contact or team advocate, working with stakeholders, helping with Delivery Manager and Product Manager DM/PM activities, improving processes.

- Contribution towards other developers: e.g. coaching / training / inspiring; encouraging L&D.

Candidates who do not adhere to the Personal Statement directions above may be rejected on this basis.

A diverse sift panel will review the information in your CV and Personal Statement to assess the sift criteria specified above. We operate an anonymous shortlisting process. Please ensure your CV and Personal Statement do not include your name or any other identifying details.

Please access the following link for guidance on how to apply - Application Guidance

Stage 2 - Interviews:

Successful candidates who meet the required standard will then be invited to a panel interview held via Microsoft Teams. At interview stage, you will be assessed against the following Success Profile elements - Experience, Technical and the following Behaviours:

- Leadership
- Working Together
- Developing Self & Others
- Making Effective Decisions
- Delivering at Pace

Appointments are made strictly in merit order. In the event that two or more candidates receive identical interview scores, the **Leadership Behaviour** will be applied as the primary lead criterion to determine the final merit order.

Should you be unsuccessful in the role that you have applied for but demonstrate the capability for a role at a lower level, we reserve the right to discuss this opportunity with you and offer you the position without needing a further application.

A reserve list may be held for up to 12 months, from which further appointments may be made.

Use of Artificial Intelligence

Artificial Intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Terms & Conditions

Please review our Terms and Conditions which set out how we recruit and provide further information related to the role and salary arrangements.

If you have any questions, please feel free to contact digitalanddatarecruitment@justice.gov.uk

Person specification

Please refer to attached Job Description

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £58,511, Ministry of Justice contributes £16,950 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides (opens in a new window).

- Access to learning and development
- A working environment that supports a range of flexible working options to enhance your work life balance
- A working culture which encourages inclusion and diversity
- A Civil Service pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%
- Annual Leave
- Public Holidays
- Season Ticket Advance

For more information about the recruitment process, benefits and allowances and answers to general queries, please click the below link which will direct you to our Candidate Information Page.

Link: https://justicejobs.tal.net/vx/candidate/cms/About%20the%20MOJ

Things you need to know

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Selection process details

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Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is security check (opens in a new window).

See our vetting charter (opens in a new window).

People working with government assets must complete baseline personnel security standard (opens in new window) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals
- nationals of the Republic of Ireland
- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS) (opens in a new window)
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)
- individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020
- Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

Further information on nationality requirements (opens in a new window)

Working for the Civil Service

The Civil Service Code (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's recruitment principles (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan (opens in a new window) and the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy (opens in a new window).

Apply and further information

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name :	SSCL Recruitment Enquiries Team
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk
Telephone :	0345 241 5359
Recruitment team	
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk

Further information

Appointment to the Civil Service is governed by the Civil Service Commission s Recruitment Principles. If you feel a department has breached the requirement of the Recruitment Principles and would like to raise this, please contact SSCL (Moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@gov.sscl.com) in the first instance. If the role has been advertised externally (outside of the Civil Service) and you are not satisfied with the response, you may bring your complaint to the Commission. For further information on bringing a complaint to the Civil Service Commission please visit their web pages: http://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/civil-service-recruitment/complaints/

https://www.jobtrain.co.uk/justicedigital/Job/JobDetail?JobId=1247

Civil Service Commission

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